



String Length & Twitter Count

Brief Overview

This note covers [JavaScript string length](#) and was created from an [uploaded document](#). It explains how to access the `.length` property, use Chrome snippets, track Twitter character limits, prompt users and handle null input, and previews the upcoming `slice` method.

Key Points

- Using `.length` to count characters in strings
- Handling prompts and null results safely
- Calculating remaining characters for Twitter posts
- Preparing to extract substrings with `slice` in future lessons

JavaScript String Length Property

Definition: The `length` property of a string returns the total number of characters it contains.

- Accessed with dot notation: `variableName.length`.
- Counts every character, including spaces and punctuation.

Using `length` in Chrome Snippets

Example: Determine the character count of a name.

```
let name = "Angela";
console.log(name.length); // 6
```

- The console prints 6, matching a manual count 1 2 3 4 5 6.

Twitter Character Count History 🧠

Version	Maximum Characters	Behavior
Original	140	Shows remaining characters; tweet is cut off at 140.
Updated	280	Allows longer tweets, but may lead to "mini-essays".

Challenge Prompt 🏆

Task: Write JavaScript that:

1. Prompts the user for a paragraph (e.g., a blog excerpt).
2. Reports how many characters have been typed.
3. Shows how many characters remain out of either **140** or **280**.
 - Expected output format:
"You have written **182** characters, you have **-42** characters left."
 - Requires string concatenation, basic arithmetic, and the `length` property.

Commenting Out Code

Single-line comment: `// comment text` – ignores everything after `//` on that line.

Multi-line comment: `/* comment text */` – can span multiple lines.

Syntax	Scope
//	Single line
/* ... */	Multiple lines

Prompt Code Example

Step-by-step implementation:

1. Prompt the user for a tweet.
2. Store the response in tweet.
3. Compute its length (tweetCount).
4. Display an alert with the character count and remaining characters.

```
let tweet = prompt("Compose your tweet");
let tweetCount = tweet.length;
alert("You have written " + tweetCount + " characters, you have " + (140 - tweetCount) + " characters remaini
```

- Example: Inputting a 187-character paragraph yields
"You have written 187 characters, you have -47 characters remaining."

Handling Null Prompt Results

Error explanation: "Cannot read property 'length' of null" occurs when the prompt is dismissed (e.g., by switching tabs) and the returned value is null. Since null lacks a length property, attempting to read it triggers the error.

- Ensure the prompt receives a value before accessing .length.
- Future lessons will cover null, undefined, and NaN.

Simplifying the Code

- The intermediate variable tweetCount can be omitted by using tweet.length directly in the alert:

```
let tweet = prompt("Compose your tweet");
alert("You have written " + tweet.length + " characters, you have " + (140 - tweet.length) + " characters rem
```

- The extra variable was added only for clarity of the logic.

Next Lesson Preview

Upcoming topic: The slice method for strings, which enables extracting substrings ("slice and dice" the text).